

1.3 THE PRINCIPLES OF FUTSAL

1.3.1 Basic core attacking concepts

Regardless of the formation adopted on the pitch or the attacking system deployed, the correct application of technical options and our ability to evaluate and analyse the game will depend to a large extent on the basic core concepts of attacking play. Generally speaking, the most basic core concepts are those that involve perception/motor or coordination skills and individual attacking tactics (individual technical/tactical options), as the greater the group aspect of the core concept, the greater the complexity. It therefore follows that these basic core concepts are the foundation upon which small-group tactics (small-group technical/tactical options) and team tactics (team technical/tactical options) may then be developed.

Basic core attacking concepts can be defined as being comprised of movement, positioning and attacking elements, executed either individually or in combination with team-mates, depending on the aim or objective of the attack (e.g. keeping the ball, developing play, finishing on goal/scoring a goal). These elements provide players with the options needed to execute effective solutions to problems they may encounter during the game. Given that decision-making relies on an analysis of the game situation, based on perception, this means that core perception and decision-making concepts are the foundation of good tactics.

The basic core attacking concepts can be categorised as follows:

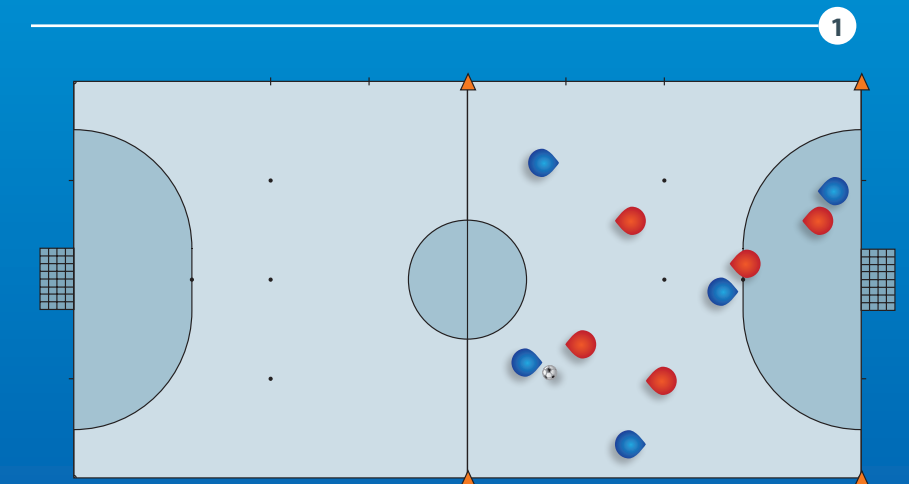
- 1. Visual command of the playing area**
Making the right decisions based on analysis of the game involves the player having a visual command of the area around them, including the position of the ball and the positions of team-mates and opponents. A player needs to know where, how and what to look for at all times of the game.

- 2. Body positioning**
This is another basic core concept that determines both the ability to perceive situations and, to a large extent, tactical intent. Positioning the body in one way or another can alter the options available with and without the ball. Positioning the body correctly in response to the game situation can increase the tactical options available, affording the player improved spatial and temporal perception of their position and situation in relation to their team-mates, opponents and the ball.
- 3. Controlling space with the ball and in relation to one's marker**
Being able to control the space needed to execute manoeuvres in a controlled manner is another key factor at a tactical level. The player's ability to position themselves at the correct distance and in the correct direction and position in relation to the defender marking them when they receive the ball or are already in possession of it involves anticipating, at all times, defensive actions while they are on the ball. In anticipating these actions the player must also bear in mind their subsequent tactical intentions. As we can see, all of these efforts are designed to make it difficult for the defender to carry out their man-marking duties.
- 4. Applying the basic core technical concepts**
As we have already seen, while passing, control, touch, dribbling and shooting are all technical elements, the use of them in any given game situation involves a prior cognitive process, namely perception and decision-making. We could say that tactics are both the cause and the effect of any technical element.
- 5. Off-the-ball movement**
This is the movement a player makes to prevent an opposing player from marking them when their team has possession of the ball. The team

must try to find spaces that will provide the player in possession with passing options. **Off-the-ball movement** can be used to **support** the player in possession or to **find gaps** in the defence, with team-mates taking up positions where a pass will enable the attacking move to continue.

- 6. Support**
This is the action taken by players without the ball to create passing options for the player in possession by means of movement off the ball. The support players must constantly seek to assist the player in possession.
- 7. Feinting**
This is a core technical/tactical concept that involves a shift or movement of the body with the aim of deceiving or confusing a direct opponent so that they themselves make a shift or movement that enables the player performing the feint to then execute a subsequent planned action.
- 8. Switching the play**
This involves the player in possession selecting a passing option that changes the focus of the play to a different area of the court in order to improve the options available to the team. The switching of play involves the player in possession shifting their body into position and moving the ball into position and then making use of it by playing a pass or running with it.

Possession game, 5v5 on a 1/2-sized court, one touch/unlimited touches



LEARNING UNIT

Individual and group technical/tactical options.

PHASE

Skills acquisition/proficiency.

CONTENT

Basic core attacking and defensive concepts. Decision-making when passing. Body positioning. Visual command of the playing area. Marking. Tackling. Closing down passing angles. Spatial awareness in switching positions.

OBJECTIVES

To improve the basic core attacking and defensive concepts needed to keep and recover possession.

NUMBER OF PLAYERS

10.

EQUIPMENT

Balls, bibs and cones.

DRILL DESCRIPTION

- Possession game on a half-sized court (20x20m), 5v5.
- Both teams try to keep possession of the ball. Once a team loses possession, it switches to defence. If the ball goes out of play, a kick-in is awarded against the team that last touched the ball.
- Conditions: if a one-touch pass is played to a team-mate, that team-mate can take as many touches as they like. However, if a player takes more than one touch, the team-mate that they pass to may only take one touch.

